

# Chasing Death to Truly Live: The Philosophy of Mortality

Seeing Life Through the Lens of Death



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## The Weight of the Inevitable

We all know death. We've seen it, felt its weight in the loss of others—yet somehow when it comes to us, it remains an abstraction. As children, the thought of our own

death feels absurd, almost impossible. But as we age, the world strips away that illusion, forcing us to confront an undeniable truth: our time is finite. And yet, when the moment finally arrives, most of us will still feel unprepared—shocked that something we always knew was inevitable is suddenly happening to us.

*"Do not act as if you had ten thousand years to live. Death hangs over you. While you live, while it is in your power, be good." — Meditations*

## Think of Yourself as Already Dead

No one wants to die. The mere thought of our own death fills us with dread. But what if you believe that you're already dead?

What if you're given the news that you're going to die this evening? Every person you were going to be rude to you'll be kind toward — because what's even the quarrel now? You become fearless where you have to be, because you know that the worst is already done. You'll go do things you were hesitant to do, you'll go start that business, you'll tell people how much you value them, and then suddenly the air you breathe becomes paradise.

Close your eyes and feel it—your final day. The weight of unspoken words, the hesitation that held you back. Now let it go. *Isn't this how you want to live? Isn't this the ideal life? To live true to yourself, to speak your mind, to make someone's life better?*

This way of thinking gives you the power to not care about things and people that don't matter and cherish those that do matter.

## Chasing Death to Truly Live

If thinking of yourself as already dead frees you, then what if you chased a moment in life where you would be ready to die? Imagine reaching that peak, a point so complete that everything after feels like a gift, a bonus to savor. To chase death this way is to hunt for a life so rich that you're ready whenever it calls.

If you were told you were only 30 failures away from succeeding —**how fast would you like to fail?** If you were told an ideal, fearless life were waiting for you on the other side of your fear of Death, filled with kindness you didn't know you possessed and brimming with love you didn't know you could give — **how fast would you chase Death?**

The Bhagavad Gita speaks of the eternal soul—an existence beyond death. But my question is: *If death is inevitable, why not make this one life so meaningful that you would seek another?*

## The Present Moment

If death is certain, and grief is fleeting, then what remains? The **present moment**. The realization of mortality should not cripple us with fear but free us from hesitation. A life well-lived is not one spent avoiding death but one spent pursuing meaning so intensely that, when the end arrives — *there is nothing left undone, no words left unsaid, no regrets weighing us down.*

So don't act tough and hide your wounds—there are people who care for you, who are watching. And it's important to realize:

*"Most of us are living our lives with our hearts half-broken — waiting for something, fearing something, never truly living. But what if we stopped waiting? What if we stopped fearing? What if we just lived?"*

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